

Apply filters to SQL queries

Project description

As a security professional at a large organization, I was tasked with investigating potential security incidents using SQL queries on the organization's employee and login data. I analyzed the `log_in_attempts` and `employees` tables to identify suspicious login activity, such as failed logins after business hours, login attempts from specific dates, and unusual patterns that could indicate a security threat. Using filters with `AND`, `OR`, `NOT`, and `LIKE` operators, I retrieved targeted information to help the team decide which employee machines needed security updates and which login attempts required further investigation. This hands-on practice strengthened my ability to use SQL effectively for real-world cybersecurity investigations.

Retrieve after hours failed login attempts

This query finds all failed login attempts that occurred after 6 PM (18:00). I used the `>` operator on the `login_time` column to filter for after-business-hours activity, and combined it with `AND success = 0` to show only failed attempts. This helps the security team investigate suspicious login activity that happened outside normal working hours.

Quarry

SELECT *

FROM log_in_attempts

WHERE login_time > '18:00:00'

AND success = '0';

```
MariaDB [organization]> select * From log_in_attempts where login_time > '18:00'and success = '0';
```

event_id	username	login_date	login_time	country	ip_address	success
2	apatel	2022-05-10	20:27:27	CAN	192.168.205.12	0
18	pwashing	2022-05-11	19:28:50	US	192.168.66.142	0
20	tshah	2022-05-12	18:56:36	MEXICO	192.168.109.50	0
28	aestrada	2022-05-09	19:28:12	MEXICO	192.168.27.57	0
34	drosas	2022-05-11	21:02:04	US	192.168.45.93	0
42	cgriffin	2022-05-09	23:04:05	US	192.168.4.157	0
52	cjackson	2022-05-10	22:07:07	CAN	192.168.58.57	0
69	wjaffrey	2022-05-11	19:55:15	USA	192.168.100.17	0
82	abernard	2022-05-12	23:38:46	MEX	192.168.234.49	0
87	apatel	2022-05-08	22:38:31	CANADA	192.168.132.153	0
96	ivelasco	2022-05-09	22:36:36	CAN	192.168.84.194	0
104	asundara	2022-05-11	18:38:07	US	192.168.96.200	0
107	bisles	2022-05-12	20:25:57	USA	192.168.116.187	0
111	aestrada	2022-05-10	22:00:26	MEXICO	192.168.76.27	0
127	abellmas	2022-05-09	21:20:51	CANADA	192.168.70.122	0
131	bisles	2022-05-09	20:03:55	US	192.168.113.171	0
155	cgriffin	2022-05-12	22:18:42	USA	192.168.236.176	0
160	jclark	2022-05-10	20:49:00	CANADA	192.168.214.49	0
199	yappiah	2022-05-11	19:34:48	MEXICO	192.168.44.232	0

19 rows in set (0.001 sec)

Retrieve login attempts on specific dates

This query retrieves all login attempts that occurred on 2022-05-08 or 2022-05-09. I used the OR operator to include both dates and the = operator on the login_date column to filter for these specific days. This helps the security team investigate suspicious activity around the date of the incident (2022-05-09) by reviewing login attempts from that day and the day before.

Quarry

```
SELECT *  
FROM log_in_attempts  
WHERE login_date = '2022-05-08'  
OR login_date = '2022-05-09'
```

```
MariaDB [organization]> select* from log_in_attempts where login_date = '2022-05-08' or login_date = '2022-05-09';
```

event_id	username	login_date	login_time	country	ip_address	success
1	jrafael	2022-05-09	04:56:27	CAN	192.168.243.140	1
3	dkot	2022-05-09	06:47:41	USA	192.168.151.162	1
4	dkot	2022-05-08	02:00:39	USA	192.168.178.71	0
8	bisles	2022-05-08	01:30:17	US	192.168.119.173	0
12	dkot	2022-05-08	09:11:34	USA	192.168.100.158	1
15	lyamamot	2022-05-09	17:17:26	USA	192.168.183.51	0
24	arusso	2022-05-09	06:49:39	MEXICO	192.168.171.192	1
25	sbaelish	2022-05-09	07:04:02	US	192.168.33.137	1
26	apatel	2022-05-08	17:27:00	CANADA	192.168.123.105	1
28	aestrada	2022-05-09	19:28:12	MEXICO	192.168.27.57	0
30	yappiah	2022-05-09	03:22:22	MEX	192.168.124.48	1
32	acook	2022-05-09	02:52:02	CANADA	192.168.142.239	0
36	asundara	2022-05-08	09:00:42	US	192.168.78.151	1
38	sbaelish	2022-05-09	14:40:01	USA	192.168.60.42	1
39	yappiah	2022-05-09	07:56:40	MEXICO	192.168.57.115	1
42	cgriffin	2022-05-09	23:04:05	US	192.168.4.157	0
43	mcouliba	2022-05-08	02:35:34	CANADA	192.168.16.208	0
44	daquino	2022-05-08	07:02:35	CANADA	192.168.168.144	0
47	dkot	2022-05-08	05:06:45	US	192.168.233.24	1
49	asundara	2022-05-08	14:00:01	US	192.168.173.213	0
53	nmason	2022-05-08	11:51:38	CAN	192.168.133.188	1
56	acook	2022-05-08	04:56:30	CAN	192.168.209.130	1
58	ivelasco	2022-05-09	17:20:54	CAN	192.168.57.162	0
61	dtanaka	2022-05-09	09:45:18	USA	192.168.98.221	1
65	aalonso	2022-05-09	23:42:12	MEX	192.168.52.37	1
66	aestrada	2022-05-08	21:58:32	MEX	192.168.67.223	1
67	abernard	2022-05-09	11:53:41	MEX	192.168.118.29	1
68	mrah	2022-05-08	17:16:13	US	192.168.42.248	1
70	tmitchel	2022-05-09	10:55:17	MEXICO	192.168.87.199	1
71	mcouliba	2022-05-09	06:57:42	CAN	192.168.55.169	0
72	alevitsk	2022-05-08	12:09:10	CANADA	192.168.139.176	1
79	abernard	2022-05-09	11:41:15	MEX	192.168.158.170	0

Retrieve login attempts outside of Mexico

This query retrieves all login attempts that did not originate from Mexico. I used the NOT operator combined with LIKE 'MEX%' to exclude any records where the country starts with

"MEX" (covering both "MEX" and "MEXICO"). This helps the security team focus on login attempts from other countries and investigate the suspicious activity that occurred outside of Mexico.

Quarry

SELECT *

FROM log_in_attempts

WHERE NOT country LIKE 'MEX%';

```
MariaDB [organization]> select* from log_in_attempts where not country like 'mex%';
```

event_id	username	login_date	login_time	country	ip_address	success
1	jrafael	2022-05-09	04:56:27	CAN	192.168.243.140	1
2	apatel	2022-05-10	20:27:27	CAN	192.168.205.12	0
3	dkot	2022-05-09	06:47:41	USA	192.168.151.162	1
4	dkot	2022-05-08	02:00:39	USA	192.168.178.71	0
5	jrafael	2022-05-11	03:05:59	CANADA	192.168.86.232	0
7	eraab	2022-05-11	01:45:14	CAN	192.168.170.243	1
8	bisles	2022-05-08	01:30:17	US	192.168.119.173	0
10	jrafael	2022-05-12	09:33:19	CANADA	192.168.228.221	0
11	sgilmore	2022-05-11	10:16:29	CANADA	192.168.140.81	0
12	dkot	2022-05-08	09:11:34	USA	192.168.100.158	1
13	mrh	2022-05-11	09:29:34	USA	192.168.246.135	1
14	sbaelish	2022-05-10	10:20:18	US	192.168.16.99	1
15	lyamamot	2022-05-09	17:17:26	USA	192.168.183.51	0
16	mcouliba	2022-05-11	06:44:22	CAN	192.168.172.189	1
17	pwashing	2022-05-11	02:33:02	USA	192.168.81.89	1
18	pwashing	2022-05-11	19:28:50	US	192.168.66.142	0
19	jhill	2022-05-12	13:09:04	US	192.168.142.245	1
21	iuduike	2022-05-11	17:50:00	US	192.168.131.147	1
25	sbaelish	2022-05-09	07:04:02	US	192.168.33.137	1
26	apatel	2022-05-08	17:27:00	CANADA	192.168.123.105	1
29	bisles	2022-05-11	01:21:22	US	192.168.85.186	0
31	acook	2022-05-12	17:36:45	CANADA	192.168.58.232	0
32	acook	2022-05-09	02:52:02	CANADA	192.168.142.239	0
33	zbernal	2022-05-11	02:52:10	US	192.168.72.59	1
34	drosas	2022-05-11	21:02:04	US	192.168.45.93	0
36	asundara	2022-05-08	09:00:42	US	192.168.78.151	1
37	eraab	2022-05-10	06:03:41	CANADA	192.168.152.148	0
38	sbaelish	2022-05-09	14:40:01	USA	192.168.60.42	1
41	apatel	2022-05-10	17:39:42	CANADA	192.168.46.207	0
42	cgriffin	2022-05-09	23:04:05	US	192.168.4.157	0
43	mcouliba	2022-05-08	02:35:34	CANADA	192.168.16.208	0
44	daquino	2022-05-08	07:02:35	CANADA	192.168.168.144	0
45	dtanaka	2022-05-11	10:28:54	US	192.168.223.157	1
46	eraab	2022-05-11	11:29:27	CAN	192.168.24.12	0
47	dkot	2022-05-08	05:06:45	US	192.168.233.24	1
48	asundara	2022-05-11	03:18:45	USA	192.168.72.10	1
49	asundara	2022-05-08	14:00:01	US	192.168.173.213	0
50	jclark	2022-05-10	10:48:02	CANADA	192.168.174.117	0

Retrieve employees in Marketing

This query retrieves all employees who work in the Marketing department and are located in the East building. I used the = operator to filter for the Marketing department and combined it with the AND operator to add a second condition. I used LIKE 'East%' on the office column to

match any office that starts with "East" (such as East-170 or East-320). This allows the team to identify exactly which employee machines in the Marketing department need security updates.

Query

```
SELECT *  
FROM employees  
WHERE department = 'Marketing'  
AND office LIKE 'East%';
```

```
MariaDB [organization]> select* from employees where department = 'marketing' and office like 'east%';  
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+  
| employee_id | device_id | username | department | office |  
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+  
| 1000 | a320b137c219 | elarson | Marketing | East-170 |  
| 1052 | a192b174c940 | jdarosa | Marketing | East-195 |  
| 1075 | x573y883z772 | fbautist | Marketing | East-267 |  
| 1088 | k865l965m233 | rgosh | Marketing | East-157 |  
| 1103 | NULL | randers | Marketing | East-460 |  
| 1156 | a184b775c707 | dellery | Marketing | East-417 |  
| 1163 | h679i515j339 | cwilliam | Marketing | East-216 |  
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+  
7 rows in set (0.001 sec)  
  
MariaDB [organization]> 
```

Retrieve employees in Finance or Sales

This query retrieves all employees who work in either the Sales or Finance departments. I used the = operator on the department column twice and combined both conditions with the OR operator. This allows the security team to identify all employees in Sales and Finance so their machines can receive the required security updates.

Query

```
SELECT *  
FROM employees  
WHERE department = 'Sales'  
OR department = 'Finance';
```

```
MariaDB [organization]> select* from employees where department = 'sales' or department ='finance';
```

employee_id	device_id	username	department	office
1003	d394e816f943	sgilmore	Finance	South-153
1007	h174i497j413	wjaffrey	Finance	North-406
1008	i858j583k571	abernard	Finance	South-170
1009	NULL	lrodriqu	Sales	South-134
1010	k242l212m542	jlansky	Finance	South-109
1011	l748m120n401	drosas	Sales	South-292
1015	p611q262r945	jsoto	Finance	North-271
1017	r550s824t230	jclark	Finance	North-188
1018	s310t540u653	abellmas	Finance	North-403
1022	w237x430y567	arusso	Finance	West-465
1024	y976z753a267	iuduike	Sales	South-215
1025	z381a365b233	jhill	Sales	North-115
1029	d336e475f676	ivelasco	Finance	East-156
1035	j236k303l245	bisles	Sales	South-171
1039	n253o917p623	cjackson	Sales	East-378
1041	p929q222r778	cgriffin	Sales	North-208
1044	s429t157u159	tbarnes	Finance	West-415
1045	t567u844v434	pwashing	Finance	East-115
1046	u429v921w138	daquino	Finance	West-280
1047	v109w587x644	cward	Finance	West-373
1048	w167x592y375	tmitchel	Finance	South-288
1049	NULL	jreckley	Finance	Central-295
1050	y132z930a114	csimmons	Finance	North-468
1057	f370g535h632	mscott	Sales	South-270
1062	k367l639m697	redwards	Finance	North-180
1063	l686m140n569	lpope	Sales	East-226
1066	o678p794q957	ttyrell	Sales	Central-444
1069	NULL	jpark	Finance	East-110

Retrieve all employees not in IT

This query retrieves all employees who are not in the Information Technology department. I used the NOT operator combined with department = 'Information Technology' to exclude anyone in IT. This helps the security team identify which employee machines still need the security update.

Query

```
SELECT *
```

```
FROM employees
```

```
WHERE NOT department = 'Information Technology';
```

```
MariaDB [organization]> select* from employees where not department = 'information technology';
```

employee_id	device_id	username	department	office
1000	a320b137c219	elarson	Marketing	East-170
1001	b239c825d303	bmoreno	Marketing	Central-276
1002	c116d593e558	tshah	Human Resources	North-434
1003	d394e816f943	sgilmore	Finance	South-153
1004	e218f877g788	eraab	Human Resources	South-127
1005	f551g340h864	gesparza	Human Resources	South-366
1007	h174i497j413	wjaffrey	Finance	North-406
1008	i858j583k571	abernard	Finance	South-170
1009	NULL	lrodriqu	Sales	South-134
1010	k242l212m542	jlansky	Finance	South-109
1011	l748m120n401	drosas	Sales	South-292
1015	p611q262r945	jsoto	Finance	North-271
1016	q793r736s288	sbaelish	Human Resources	North-229
1017	r550s824t230	jclark	Finance	North-188
1018	s310t540u653	abellmas	Finance	North-403
1020	u899v381w363	arutley	Marketing	South-351
1022	w237x430y567	arusso	Finance	West-465
1024	y976z753a267	iuduike	Sales	South-215
1025	z381a365b233	jhill	Sales	North-115
1026	a998b568c863	apatel	Human Resources	West-320
1027	b806c503d354	mrah	Marketing	West-246
1028	c603d749e374	astrada	Human Resources	West-121
1029	d336e475f676	ivelasco	Finance	East-156
1030	e391f189g913	mabadi	Marketing	West-375
1031	f419g188h578	dkot	Marketing	West-408
1034	i679j565k940	bsand	Human Resources	East-484
1035	j236k303l245	bisles	Sales	South-171
1036	k550l533m205	rjensen	Marketing	Central-239
1038	m873n636o225	btang	Human Resources	Central-260
1039	n253o917p623	cjackson	Sales	East-378
1040	o783p832q294	dtarly	Human Resources	East-237
1041	p929q222r778	cgriffin	Sales	North-208
1042	q175r338s833	acook	Human Resources	West-381
1044	s429t157u159	tbarnes	Finance	West-415
1045	t567u844v434	pwashing	Finance	East-115
1046	u429v921w138	daquino	Finance	West-280
1047	v109w587x644	cward	Finance	West-373
1048	w167x592y375	tmitchel	Finance	South-288
1049	NULL	jreckley	Finance	Central-295
1050	y132z930a114	csimmons	Finance	North-468

Summary

In this portfolio activity, I used SQL filters to investigate potential security incidents and support security updates across the organization. By applying operators such as AND, OR, NOT, and LIKE, I was able to extract targeted information from the log_in_attempts and employees tables, including after-hours failed logins, suspicious activity on specific dates, login attempts outside Mexico, and employees in specific departments who required updates. This exercise strengthened my ability to write effective SQL queries for real-world cybersecurity tasks. It demonstrated how proper filtering can help security teams quickly identify risks and take action to protect the organization's systems and data.